

Petitions QC Discovery Research

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Overview

The United States Tax Court (USTC) is a federal trial court that specializes in adjudicating disputes over federal income tax prior to formal Internal Revenue Service (IRS) tax assessments. DAWSON is the case management system that is currently utilized by court users to perform their day to day duties. DAWSON replaced the legacy system, Blackstone.

During February - March 2023, the team's UX Researchers and Designers used a human-centered design framework to better understand the experiences of Petitions Clerks in regards to the QC'ing process on DAWSON and highlighted key insights to inform future opportunities for improvement.

Purpose

The purpose of this research is to engage with USTC Petitions Clerks to better understand their experiences with the QC'ing process of petitions (both e-file and paper). Insights discovered through this research will help us identify opportunities for improvement and inform 1 Epic with 2 associated stories at this time which outline the following objectives:

[EPIC] 5817: Usability Study: Court users -Petitions QC and other associated flows

- Discover any issues users have completing an end-to-end QC of an e-filed petition
- Discover any issues users have entering and processing a paper petition and associated documents
- Determine if users can locate and complete an Order during the Petition process
- Discover feature gaps or workarounds required for MVP launch

Story 7771: Disclosure Cases --Need to be Sealed

- Validate the AC-upon filing cases, with caseType of "Disclosure" need to be sealed

Story 2765: Petitions -Check to see if P has another case (POST -MVP)

- Determine whether or not noting another pending case would improve the user experience and if so, inform the design and usability of the notification.

Research Goals

The overall purpose of this research is as follows:

- Understand and document the unique perspectives, needs and experiences of Petitions Clerks as related to the QC'ing process of petitions (both e-file and paper)
- Define key moments in the user's experiences to identify opportunities to improve the QC'ing process
- Create an enhanced user experience across DAWSON'S QC'ing process

Approach

The following research method was utilized in order to gain an understanding of the user base:

Method

- 1:1 non-standardized interviews –in-depth interviews to understand users’ challenges, needs and experiences using DAWSON for consolidation
- Duration of 45-60 minutes
- Scheduled remotely via Zoom

Engagement Groups

In order to gather diverse perspectives from people that utilize DAWSON, we included input from users who use DAWSON frequently and have extensive experience with QC’ing petitions, both e-file and paper. The experiences, pain points, bright spots, and other insights of these users are the core of this report and will serve as the starting point for future enhancements to DAWSON.

Throughout this research process, we engaged with the following user types:

- **Petitions Clerk Supervisor** - people who coordinate certain support functions integral to the effective processing of petitions, including assigning petitions for review, ensuring fees have been paid, and overseeing the successful completion of petition QCs.
- **Petitions Clerk** - people who assist the Petitions Clerk Supervisor with coordination of certain support functions integral to the effective processing of Petitions, including processing e-files, and paper files.

User Type Breakdown

3 users participated in an interview:

- 1 Petitions Clerk Supervisor
- 2 Petitions Clerks

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Data points represent feedback gathered directly from the end users and thus most often take the form of direct quotes. The content of those quotes and experiences are considered qualitative data, but can be quantified as data points.

10

Key insights uncover context and illustrate pain points and bright spots through subjective analysis. They help us identify opportunities about the user experience that inspire actionable solutions.

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Themes identify a commonality or pattern between a group of data points. They describe what is happening from an objective standpoint.



Synthesis

The in-depth interviews provided qualitative raw data in the form of first-hand accounts and quotes directly from the DAWSON user community. Through an affinity mapping process, raw data was grouped to identify themes and uncover insights that point to opportunities to improve DAWSON and quantify the data. This process enables us to analyze the data from broad higher level themes while still allowing us to drill down to the detailed data points.

Opportunities

Opportunities are developed for each insight. These are phrased as “How might we” questions and used as a method to jump-start thinking about ways in which we can address the users’ identified pain points and challenges.

Key Insights

1

Entering statistics from the IRS Notice can be challenging due to the UI

- The "Calculate Penalties" modal obstructs the IRS Notice PDF view, making it difficult to view and enter statistics into the modal
- The form and the PDF viewer scroll in sync, so for multiple tax year statistics, the Clerk has to repeatedly scroll between the two
- With recent updates, Clerks noted additional clicks for "\$0" penalty entries

2

"Imperfect" petitions result in extra work to process

- Paper petitions can be received in unconventional forms, like a sticky note or greeting card

3

Petitions Supervisor noted that the absence of pay.gov fees on DAWSON results in printouts and manual cross-checks for assignments

- Assigning petitions involves printing lists of QC items and fees from pay.gov, cross-checking them, then handing them directly to clerks every morning
- The Supervisor stated that it would be helpful if pay.gov fees could be automatically fed into DAWSON

4

Party information fields clear out when the party type is changed

- Party information has to be captured and re-entered when party type is changed

5

Petitions Clerks are unable to add counsel in the Parties tab during QC

- Only the counsel who e-filed the petition is entered into the case initially

6

Cover sheets for petitions do not reflect changes made during QC

- Changes saved in an e-filed petition during QC are not reflected in the cover sheets
- For paper petitions, changes to mailing dates, an important data point, are reflected on the Review and Serve page, but not in the cover sheet

7

Mailing date and delivery type are important data points

- Mailing date can impact if a case is accepted or dismissed, so accurate scanning of envelopes is critical
- Clerks must capture delivery type but have no dedicated form field to do so

Key Insights Continued

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Clerks review information for accuracy on the Review and Serve page and print it out for manual order reminders

- Review and Serve is the last chance to verify entered information is correct
- When QCing e-filed petitions, Clerks must navigate between the Review and Serve page and the PDF to compare information
- The Review and Serve page is printed as a physical reminder of what Orders need to be manually created

9

Automatic navigation to QC Inbox after service may result in draft documents being forgotten

- Clerks must re-navigate to the case they just served to issue draft documents
- Lack of reminders for draft documents increases the risk of Orders not being issued

10

Scanning paper petitions is time consuming and not user friendly

- DAWSON lacks the functionality to rotate or delete scanned pages, which then requires scanning multiple pages/batches separately
- Clerks often resort to using Adobe as a workaround for scanning

Entering statistics from the IRS Notice can be challenging due to the UI

When Petitions Clerks are entering statistics in the IRS Notice tab, they note that it can be challenging for a few reasons. The modal to calculate penalties obstructs the PDF view of the notice that Clerks refer to during QC. Further, the form and PDF viewer scroll in sync, resulting in repeated scrolling between the two. There are now extra steps to enter data in the penalties field.

“Now we do have a couple more clicks.

User 002

The “Calculate Penalties” modal obstructs the IRS Notice PDF view, making it difficult to view and enter statistics into the modal

In order to add penalties, Petitions Clerks have to click to open the Calculate Penalties modal, which appears in the center of the screen. Once opened, the modal obstructs the needed information in the PDF.

“If we could move this box [Calculate penalties modal], we can’t move this box, so if I could slide this box on the left and then scroll on the right to input the information...”

User 003

The form and the PDF viewer scroll in sync, so for multiple tax year statistics, the Clerk has to repeatedly scroll between the two

When a year/period is added to the statistics, the form increases in height to adjust for the new fields. The form and PDF viewer will scroll together so that if the Petitions Clerk is in a field near the bottom of a long form, they’ll need to scroll back up to the viewer to get the information and then scroll down to enter it.

“So let’s just say we’re going to add another year. So say we have the notice, so here [in year field] when I add in the information...you see how this stays still [the PDF viewer] but the left side still goes. A lot of times we have to...either print a copy of the notice or hand write it so we can add the rest of the notices because the right side don’t scroll down according to the left side. So then you’re like what was that one, then you’re jumping over here, then you’re going over here [scrolling between the form and the PDF viewer].

User 003

With recent updates, Clerks noted additional clicks for “\$0” penalty entries

The UI to add penalties was recently updated so that even if a penalty was zero, the modal was required to enter it, turning one click into multiple clicks. The reason for the update was so that the itemization of the penalties could be preserved. Petitions Clerks felt the previous way to enter a penalty of “\$0” was faster.

“ We used to just tab over and if there was just one penalty like there is on this one we would just be able to type it in. Now we do have a couple more clicks. That part doesn’t bother me the most. It’s when there are no penalties...we can’t just leave it blank. Even if there’s no penalties we have to go in, hit zero and get out. And this used to just be fillable like this one immediately, so we used to do tab, [enter] zero, done.

User 002

Opportunities

- **How might we** improve the UI so that entering statistics is more efficient?
- **How might we** make it easier to enter a penalty of “0” into the statistics?

“Imperfect” petitions result in extra work to process

When petitions are received that don’t conform to the standards of the court, they are considered “imperfect” petitions. They have come in unconventional forms and require extra processing.

“Paper petitions just take a little bit more work. ...we can get paper petitions literally on sticky notes.

User 002

Paper petitions can be received in unconventional forms, like a sticky note or greeting card

The court has a protocol to determine how “imperfect” petitions are processed. They may require different Orders to adhere to the standards of what is needed for a case.

“I’ve literally got a greeting card one time and they wrote their petition on the back of their happy birthday card that their mom sent them. The envelope that was with it said happy birthday. We get the wildest things so paper petitions can be a lot more difficult in the sense that the paper can be nasty or it can be perfectly in line.

User 004

Opportunities

- How might we reduce the extra work required of the Court for “imperfect” petitions?

Petitions Supervisor noted that the absence of pay.gov fees on DAWSON results in printouts and manual cross-checks for assignments

The process of assigning petitions is a manual one for the Petitions Supervisor. Instead of assigning the petitions in DAWSON, the Supervisor prints out lists of QC petitions as well as the pay.gov paid filing fees and then cross-checks them. Once verified, these lists are then divided and then handed to the Petitions Clerks to work on.

“ I’m not sending anything electronically because it would be more strenuous because of the filing fees.

User 003

Assigning petitions involves printing lists of QC items and fees from pay.gov, cross-checking them, then handing them directly to clerks every morning

The Supervisor indicated that if petitions were assigned electronically in DAWSON, it would be "more strenuous" due to having to enter a note in each case that was paid and the clerk needing to read the notes in each case. Petitions that have not been paid require an Order of Filing Fee.

“ Every morning when I come in I print out the pay.gov information, and then I print out our QC box so then I would look on the pay.gov printout and then mark on the QC printout what was paid. So I’ll just put the date. So this morning I did 2/14 on the printout.

User 003

“ I’m not sending anything electronically because it would be more strenuous because of the filing fees. Because when I send a case I’m going to have to put a note in the case the filing fee is paid, and then they would have to go into the notes to read that the filing fee is paid, then apply it to the petition...because there’s no way for us to track the filing fees in DAWSON.

User 003

The Supervisor stated that it would be helpful if pay.gov fees could be automatically fed into DAWSON

Since pay.gov fees are not in DAWSON, the Supervisor assigns QC items manually on paper instead of electronically. Having the fees automatically fed into DAWSON would also help Petitions Clerks know which ones have been paid or not during QC.

“ ...would be even better is that when they do make their pay.gov payment it automatically pops up within the case, and then that’s one less thing we would have to worry about. So then once we QC it the filing fee is paid and then we could keep moving because sometimes petitioners get confused...if they submitted their e-file petition today and they made their payment, it’s not going to be QC’d or the payment is not going to be registered until tomorrow because I only print the pay.gov payments once a day.

User 003

“ So how it’ll have the date, the 16th, that lets me know it’s paid today, the filing fee was paid. And then of course I highlight the ones where it wasn’t paid so I don’t get ‘em mixed up because it’s easy to do. So that means that it wasn’t paid so then I’ll issue an order for that taxpayer.

User 004

Opportunities

- **How might we** make it easier for the Supervisor to verify fee payment status?

Party information fields clear out when the party type is changed

Users need to remember to copy the parties information before changing the party type, otherwise the original information is lost unless the user cancels the operation. Because petitioners don't always enter the correct party type, users find this to be a pain point when they have to change it.

“ If we could switch within the party types without losing the information, yes.

User 003

Party information has to be captured and re-entered when party type is changed

If a clerk has to change a party type for any reason, party information fields are cleared out and they have to re-enter all information whether it's paper or e-filed. This creates extra work and is time consuming.

“ If it's a husband and wife in a case, but when they selected the party type they only selected petitioner, now we have to go in and select petition and spouse. Any information that's on this side [the form in the Parties tab] when we change it from petitioner to petitioner and spouse, we lose it. If we change it, we have to manually write down the address to make sure we don't lose it because once we switch out, it deletes the information that they inputted in.

User 003

“ When a taxpayer puts one person on the petition and when I get ready to QC, I see that it's two people and then I have to go in and once I click two petitioners, it erases everything. It erases their phone numbers, everything. So that can be a little time consuming, but it normally doesn't happen that often but it does happen. I don't expect the taxpayers to always do it right anyway.

User 004

Opportunities

- How might we alleviate users' cognitive load for recalling party information?

Petitions Clerks are unable to add counsel in the Parties tab during QC

During the QC process, when a Petitions Clerk is adding party information, they can't add counsel information. Clerks noted that this slows down their process as they must use a workaround of navigating to another page to add the counsel then return to the petition QC. Clerks voiced they wished they could add all the relevant counsel while they are already on the Parties information section in order to reduce processing time and avoid unnecessary navigation away from the page.

“ If there's multiple attorneys we would have to manually add them in.

User 003

Only the counsel who e-filed the petition is entered into the case initially

Cases may have multiple counsel, but the filing counsel is the only one that gets entered initially. The Petitions Clerk must interrupt their QC flow and navigate away from the page to manually add in any other counsel in the docket's Case information tab.

“ If there was a way we could add another counsel under this party's screen, let's just say that that would help instead of me literally going back here, case information, select the party, to add them in and then I gotta go back into the case again, go back into the review and serve to finish out the QCing process.

User 003

“ If it's multiple attorneys, only the attorney that's submitting the petition, their information would be in the case. But then we would have to manually add the others in.

User 003

Opportunities

- How might we create a more efficient flow for entering petitioner counsel during the QC process?

Cover sheets for petitions do not reflect changes made during QC

In order to create an intuitive user flow, DAWSON should reflect up-to-date accurate information. Although petitioner information populates exactly as initially entered in the cover sheets, this is not the case for any additional saved changes. The saved changes appear on the Review and Serve page but not in the cover sheets.

“ We have no way once I’ve served it to go in and change it.

User 003

Changes saved in an e-filed petition during QC are not reflected in the cover sheets

Clerks report that when they update any information in the petition during the QC process, these changes are not reflected in the cover sheet. Although changes ultimately do appear in subsequent cover sheets, there is a need to have that information reflect accurately as soon as the change is saved since they appear on the Review and Serve page.

“ Eventually when documents are filed, after that, it’ll be the correct way, but it’s just that initial start here that it does not change the cover sheet.

User 003

For paper petitions, changes to mailing dates, an important data point, are reflected on the Review and Serve page, but not in the cover sheet

The mailing date is very important as it determines if a case is accepted due to its notice date. However, Petitions Clerks only have one opportunity initially (before saving for later) to ensure that the mailing date is entered correctly. After that, when the Clerk changes the date, it is reflected on the Review and Serve page but not in the cover sheet after service.

“ So let’s say right now I’m about to do a paper petition and I put the date in here and it’s wrong. As long as I can catch that error in this screen, in this part of the case I’m ok. But once I come out of here to do my last review and serve, where I proofread and that’s commonly where it can be caught that the date is wrong and I say oh let me go back in, it’s not going to change it. It’s too late.

User 004

“ For paper petitions it is probably one of the most important things...the problem with this is if I type in that the postmark was May 24th and it actually was May 25th we have no way once I’ve served it to go in and change it. There’s nowhere that it even appears that we could correct it so then that’s where our scanning comes into play very intensely with envelopes.

User 003

Opportunities

- **How might we** improve the accuracy of cover sheets?
- **How might we** address the disconnect of seeing changes on the Review and Serve page but not in cover sheets?

Mailing date and delivery type are important data points

Petitions Clerks indicate that the mailing date and delivery type are extremely important for the Tax Court. This information could impact if the case is accepted or dismissed due to a past-due postmarked date.

“ The taxpayer has a certain time that they have to get the petition in and if it’s past that date we don’t have jurisdiction. So their case could be closed out just because it’s postmarked two days after their due date.

User 003

Mailing date can impact if a case is accepted or dismissed, so accurate scanning of envelopes is critical

Petitions Clerks must scan in all envelopes in which petitions are mailed in order to capture the mailing date. This step is particularly important because a case can potentially be dismissed if the mailing date isn't clear on the scanned envelope. Unfortunately, there are instances where the envelope may not be legible or could be severely damaged. When this occurs, the IRS Chief Counsel's office may call and request confirmation of the date, which could potentially result in the case being dismissed if it can't be confirmed.

“ The Postmark date is important because the taxpayer can say that they was late. They can say, you submitted your petition too late...the IRS will look at the envelope anyway because they can see the scan...I just want to make sure the date is right.

User 004

“ If for some reason we didn’t we always scan in the envelopes and try – you know sometimes the post office destroys these [envelopes] then we’re really screwed or the petitioner is but they can still clearly see that it says January 6th and where that comes into play is the court only has jurisdiction for 90 days...if we didn’t scan it in properly and they couldn’t see it there’s a potential it could get thrown out for us not scanning it properly.

User 002

“ We get calls from Chief Counsel’s office, which is the IRS, about the postmarks and meters because some envelopes just don’t scan very well. It’ll appear black, and so we have to pull a file and confirm with the IRS that it was timely.

User 002

Clerks must capture delivery type but have no dedicated form field to do so

Petitions Clerks are also entering delivery type in the Mailing Date field, such as Fedex, UPS, postmark, postmeter, etc. Clerks indicated that the most common delivery types they have seen are postmark and postmeter and listed Fedex, UPS, Click’N’Ship, Stamps.com, and Endicia as the remaining types.

“ We have Fedex, UPS, Postmarked, Postmetered, and then we have click’n’ship is one that we use and Stamps.com and postage by Endicia so those are the main seven ones that we see a lot.

User 003

“ The highest is the postmarked and postmeters.

User 003

Opportunities

- **How might we** make it easier to capture delivery type information?

Clerks review information for accuracy on the Review and Serve page and print it out for manual order reminders

The Review and Serve page is the last chance in the QC process for the Petitions Clerk to verify all entered information is correct. For paper petitions, Clerks must compare the physical documents to the entered information, whereas for e-filed petitions they must leave the Review and Serve page and go back into the edit state to refer to the PDF. This page is also printed out to serve as a physical reminder of what orders/notices need to be manually created and is forwarded to the Supervisor or another section.

“ If I can catch that error in this screen...I'm ok. But once I come out of here to do my last review and serve page... it's not going to change it. It's too late.

User 004

Review and Serve is the last chance to verify entered information is correct

When Clerks get to the Review and Serve page, they are reviewing the petition for the final time before serving. They are primarily focusing on grammar, spelling, punctuation, and accuracy of data.

“ The review and serve page is the page I use to do my last QC to check before I serve it. So I'll use that screen to check the name, to make sure I spelled the name right, make sure my punctuation is right, my address, small tax case regular, because this is it, once I look at it that last time and it's served then it's gone. So I use that review and serve sheet just to review, like what it says review and serve.

User 004

“ So then once we go to Review Petition...it'll just say we can save and serve it, or we can save it for later and then we would just serve it out and it'll just be removed from my QC box.

User 003

“ No action [taken], we would just review everything to make sure that everything is correct and then we would serve it out. But it would give us a breakdown of if we have to issue orders or notices. And we need that sheet because we submit that sheet to somebody else and they issue those orders. So now all orders are automatically generated. Some of our orders still have to be done manually.

User 003

When QCing e-filed petitions, Clerks must navigate between the Review and Serve page and the PDF to compare information

When doing the final QC on e-filed petitions, Clerks currently have to go back and forth between the PDF and the Review and Serve page in order to compare the information. With paper petitions, they are physically holding the paper documents and visually comparing them to the information on Review and Serve page.

“ So you come in and review and serve, it takes us to this screen where you just kind of match.

User 002

“ With e-file I kinda gotta go back and forth, sometimes I'll go back. Normally I check with e-file as I do each screen like the party screen, IRS notice screen, I kinda review it there. And then once I go to review and serve then I look again for like punctuation and sometimes I second guess myself, I might say let me check again, make sure small tax or regular. And I kinda have to go back and forth for e-file. With paper I can just hold it up and I can just look. I can look like you know, hold it in my hand and actually look at the review. E-file I kinda gotta go back and forth.

User 004

The Review and Serve page is printed as a physical reminder of what Orders need to be manually created

Once the Petitions Clerk verifies the Petitioner's entered information, they will print out the Review and Serve page. This page shows the list of Orders and Notices that need to be manually created, which would then be sent to the Petitions Supervisor or another section (docket, ADC, CS Director).

“ We would print it out. Yes [easier to manage] because that way we keep a hold on– it puts us on notice of orders that has to be done manually. Because we're not doing those orders. So the amended petition, the filing fee orders, the notice in the nature of evidence automatically comes out. But a ratification of petition does not, so we will print that review and serve sheet, we will print that out and then we will mark who needs that order if it's a husband and wife, if it's kim jones and jim jones we will put in there 'jim jones needs a ratification order'. And then someone else will pick that up and issue those orders.

User 003

“ “Yes [we physically print Review and Serve page], or we just scan it in and email it to them.

User 003

“ I email it [list of manual orders] or she [CS Director] comes to the building and she'll just grab the sheets for that day. Yes [she's the only one I send the list to] and then she will delegate or do them herself. I think so then she's just forwarding the email.

User 003

Opportunities

- **How might we** make it easier to compare information for e-filed petitions?
- **How might we** reduce the need for clerks to rely on print outs for manual orders?

Automatic navigation to QC Inbox after service may result in draft documents being forgotten

After a petition is served, DAWSON navigates the Clerks to their QC Inbox. If they have other tasks, they could forget they have orders awaiting service. Clerks must manually navigate back to the case to check if there are draft documents. There is no reminder or notification that they were not issued. Relying on the Clerk's memory increases cognitive load thus impacting the completion of Orders.

“ It doesn't always take you back to the case which gets a little problematic.

User 002

Clerks must re-navigate to the case they just served to issue draft documents

DAWSON navigates the Petitions Clerk back to their QC Inbox after a petition is served. However, to issue the draft documents, the Clerk has to navigate back into the Drafts tab of the case. If they have other tasks (e.g. phone duty), they could forget that they have Orders awaiting service.

“ Sometimes when you hit serve, DAWSON just takes you straight back to this screen [My Document QC Inbox]...if you did serve out a case and you just didn't remember that it automatically generated some orders and then if you move on to the next case, those orders don't just serve themselves. They'll just sit there in the Drafts box and there's nothing that'll tell us hey you didn't go serve your order or anything. It takes going back, reviewing cases either once they're way further along in the process or if you do it yourself, a lot of us do go back and review our stuff but sometimes we're busier than others. And the case would get all the way to where it could go to trial but the filing fee was never ordered.

User 002

“ Sometimes its just hard if we're on the phone because we also answer phones so if we're on the phone while we're also working, if it takes us back to this screen [My Document QC inbox] is when we have to do the extra, 'oh shoot it didn't take me to the right screen'.

User 002

“ It doesn't redirect, you gotta be mindful of that, cause sometimes when I would select e-file, when i serve out the e-file petitions I'll go back just to make sure that I did serve all those orders because sometimes it [forgetting] can happen, you're human.

User 003

Lack of reminders for draft documents increases the risk of Orders not being issued

After a petition is served, Orders will sit in the Drafts tab of a case until they are issued. If the Petitions Clerk forgets to return to the case and manually check that tab after the petition is served, they could miss orders or order something too late, which may impact the case.

“ Once we go back into the case, it'll have a number here [Drafts tab], that lets us know, so say we needed a notice and an order for filing fee, it'll be a number 2 here. And then we could just click on this and the orders will be there and then we can go in and serve those orders out. But if we do not go back into the case, you wouldn't know. You just gotta remember to go back into the case to serve out those orders.

User 003

Opportunities

- **How might we** reduce users' cognitive load for remembering to issue draft Orders?

Scanning paper petitions is time consuming and not user friendly.

Paper petitions may contain many pages (90 was given as an example of a large scan). These pages may not all be oriented in the same direction or may contain blank pages. The scanning functionality in DAWSON doesn't allow users to rotate or delete pages. This results in users having to scan in smaller batches or use Adobe as a workaround.

“With paper petitions, the scanning I think is the hardest thing. DAWSON is very particular.

User 002

DAWSON lacks the functionality to rotate or delete scanned pages, which then requires scanning multiple pages/batches separately

DAWSON's scanning functionality doesn't include rotating or deleting pages so when petitioner documents have different orientations (landscape, portrait) or are single or double sided, Petitions Clerks have to scan those pages separately. Blank pages are removed for scanning. Scanning entails changing the settings (flatbed, single or double sided) and if they scanned a page mistakenly or if the scanner crashes, the whole section has to be rescanned.

“For example, this page is right side up or what not. But then like this one, this evidence here, is like, it needs to be this way, but it's this way. So if I put it in there the scan is going to come out the wrong way. So I get all my pages going in the right way and I got this one little one that's wrong but I can't fix it in DAWSON because DAWSON doesn't give me the ability to do that.

User 004

“We would have to constantly keep changing [scanner settings] if it's on the flatbed, if it's double-sided or single-sided. There's not a way that we can scan all 50 pages double-sided and then go in and delete those blank pages. So if the first 5 pages is double-sided, we scan the first 5 double-sided. Then the next 3 pages is single-sided, we scan those single-sided, we select single-sided so it's kind of going back and forth, back and forth. That's our little struggle we got.

User 003

“Also DAWSON doesn't handle large scans very well, so we can scan in 200 pages and it'll crash and then it won't take any of it... DAWSON has been notorious for just either kicking you out in the middle of a big scan or if something misfeeds in DAWSON it cancels out the whole scan instead of saving it and then you just restart.

User 002

Clerks often resort to using Adobe as a workaround for scanning

Due to scanning issues in DAWSON, users resort to Adobe for scanning. Adobe allows rotating and deleting pages, as well as being less prone to crashing during scans. This workaround is still an extra step outside of DAWSON.

“ I’d rather just have it done the right way before I serve it which makes me have to use Adobe. Sometimes I have to use Adobe just so it can all look right.

User 004

“ So I know personally if I have a big document...I scan it into Adobe first and then I save it and then I upload it instead of scanning directly into DAWSON because DAWSON has been notorious for just either kicking you out in the middle of a big scan or if something misfeeds in DAWSON it cancels out the whole scan instead of saving it...in Adobe it’ll save everything that’s already scanned and you just start from there.

User 002

Opportunities

- **How might we** make scanning easier for Petitions Clerks?

Next Steps

The insights discovered through this research effort will inform future improvements to DAWSON. By utilizing these insights to empathize with and address users' needs, we can continue to provide a great experience for all those involved in the consolidation process at USTC.

Opportunities

This report has revealed many opportunities, which will serve as a great starting point for collaborative discussions. The next step in this process will be to transform these opportunities from ideas to actionable items.

UX will continue to work closely with USTC stakeholders and Flexion team members to facilitate the prioritization of the opportunities to include the potential impact and level of effort required, as well as alignment with business goals.

“It’s pretty user friendly I would say...It’s much nicer of a system than Blackstone.

User 002